Retrieval quality on the committed dataset

- 8 of 8 answerable questions answered with citations
- 2 of 2 unanswerable questions declined

Corpus size

- 5 markdown notes, 79,581 characters
- 317 chunks at 350 characters with 70 of overlap

Why top-k is 5

- k=10 cost 3.4x the context
- for a 0.06 drop in mean relevance
- and spent three slots on duplicate neighbours

Why top-k is not 3

- k=3 answered correctly
- but drew on too few source documents

The gap that defeats a threshold

- unanswerable question scored 0.3386
- weakest useful answer scored 0.3655
- a gap of 0.027

Keyword search, for comparison

- agreed with semantic search on 0 of 3 top results
- every candidate tied at 0.2857
- so its ranking carried no information

Embedding dimensions

- 384 numbers per chunk
- same count for 7 characters or 196

What the console taught me

- cp1252 cannot encode an arrow or an em dash
- printing one killed the script
- the crash came from display, not from logic